



Citizen Developer

A key initiative in many organizations is to reduce IT workload by empowering “citizen developers” with the tools and processes needed to build their own applications on the Now Platform. Citizen developers assist in the development of business-critical applications, freeing up IT departments to focus more of their energies on projects that demand technology expertise.

Citizen developer and types of development tools

A citizen developer is a user who creates new business applications for consumption by others, using development and runtime environments sanctioned by corporate IT.

Different types of development tools have emerged, and they are:

- No-code: Allows non-developers to create and maintain business applications through graphical user interfaces and configuration, with no need or ability to write traditional code
 - Low-code: Allows developers of varying skill level to create and maintain business applications through graphical user interfaces and configuration that can be supplemented with limited code
 - Pro-code: Traditional development activity where business applications are defined predominately in code, requiring detailed understanding of the API's and language constructs
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Citizen developer framework

Leverage the framework to establish a governance model to encourage a citizen developer ecosystem.

- Enable: Ensures program awareness is communicated and training/resources are available for citizen developers to begin
- Equip: Provides the tools, support, and framework for citizen developers to operate safely
- Control: As with any development, control and standards must be adhered to:
 - Development standards
 - Documentation to help others support the application
 - Definitions for data the application will need
 - Testing expectations



Business concerns

Anticipate concerns with the citizen developer program and be prepared to address them. Possible concerns:

- With so many users creating applications on the platform, there is a risk of applications overlapping
- The newly populated and accurate CMDB may be affected by citizen developers
- The ISO 27001 auditor will want to know how newly developed applications are released and may want large quantities of documentation

Low-code, no-code, and pro-code development tools

Low and no-code tools	Pro-code tools
• Service Portal • App Engine Studio • Business rules • Flow Designer • Integration hub • Virtual Agent • Performance analytics and reporting	• Script includes • Workspace widgets and the seismic framework • Custom spokes